



OCTOBER 2026

PRESIDENT: Clive Higgle 027 345 5000

SECRETARY: Roscoe Lord 028 400 1660

TREASURER: Andrew Kidd andrew@abkidd.co.nz

CLUB CAPTAIN: Lloyd wanganuiclassic@gmail.com

CONTACT: wanganuiclassic@gmail.com

Meetings: First Tuesday of month, 7.30pm, Barracks Sport Bar, St Hill Street.

Monthly Ride: First Sunday after meeting, 10.00am, BP London St.

Kickstart Ride: Third Saturday after meeting, 2.00pm, BP London St.

Clive's piece

It was quite sobering to see, in the Norton Owners newsletter, the result of an over-tickled carb and a carb flashback. BIKE ON FIRE. No, not the title of a movie but the process the Norton ES2 went through. No more starting of bikes, inside, with no air cleaner, that need that tickle. Perhaps also have a practice session with a fire extinguisher.

Well, thank you to Doug for organising and leading the trip to the Marton Malting Mill. Soon to be, unfortunately, closed down because of a whole host of reasons. It was a great outing, well supported by club members. It needs a full write-up, with photos.

Our September kickstart and shed visit was also a great success. The day was unsettled but it looked as if it would be okey-doke. But just as we left the BP, the rain started, so my carefully planned, devious urban route was abandoned in favour of a quick direct route. Of course, once we had been at Russell and Ngaire's for a while, the sun peeked through. This shed visit was to their work and bike etc space. Other parts of this large industrial building are used for storage by others. It is all owned and also used by their son Paul. When we arrived, AlanH said he was an apprentice in the building firm that built it, back in the '50s (haha, just kidding Alan, more likely the '80s). Russell is an engineer and, more specifically these days, works on adapting wheels for specific needs. This involves amazing gear, skills etc.

Russell's bikes were here, mostly. Perhaps three Ariels, an old Royal Enfield, Moto Guzzi, NSU, a Beta, a Chang Jiang motorcycle and sidecar, and a new addition, a Panther Model 100 600cc motorbike and sidecar. All in perfect running order. A beautiful afternoon tea. Great thanks to Russell and Ngaire, Paul and his/their lovely young golden lab.

Our Thursday morning coffee meets are going great. This last week, Sam arrived on a Francis Barnett 225cc, its inaugural run. A great looker, and sounded awesome!

Our calendar is going well. We're at the setting up stage. If you know of event dates, let JohnM know.

See you Tuesday, for our monthly meeting.

Clive

Hawkes Bay Rally

Stoney Creek Ranch

I made a late decision enter the Hawkes Bay Classic Motorcycle Club Annual Rally and thought I'd take the 67 Bonneville TT, compete with original factory open exhaust. The weather forecast was finally looking a bit better by rally weekend, and with the bike loaded in the back of the van I was off to the Hawkes Bay. After sorting out a good sleeping spot, catching up with the usual suspects, and then dinner, most of the Friday night was spent outside around one of the well stoked fire braziers.

Saturday morning the sun was shining and time for the bike show and judging, then a 200km ride. First stop was fuel top-up, then 70kms south to the lunch stop at Pourerere Beach. About 10kms after the fuel stop the bike in front of me pulled over and had cut out on one cylinder. I stopped and after we worked out it's electrical problem, it was loaded on the recovery vehicle. By now everyone else had gone, so I had a very enjoyable run over some awesome motorbike roads, bike was purring happily, and no traffic, just the corner marshals. Then 40kms later my bike cut out, no spark. I disconnected the only ignition wire at the kill switch but still no go. My turn to wait for the recovery van. After half an hour a car pulled up and we discovered the recovery vehicle had gone to the wrong beach, so I parked the bike at a local farm driveway and hitched a ride the last 9kms to the beach and lunch. Eventually the van arrived at the correct beach, so after lunch we picked up my bike, then back to the camp.

After Saturday night dinner the class winners were announced, nothing for me, but a very tidy 68 Commando 750S from the Nelson Club won the 60 – 70 class, a very deserving winner. The rest of the evening was spent much the same as the last, outside around the fire.

On Sunday morning I woke to the sounds of light rain, after breakfast I could see some very dark clouds approaching, so got the bike in the van just as the rain started proper. A few farewells and thanks, then headed for home.

A couple of days later I took the tank off and found the kill switch wire had worked it's way into a tight gap and earthed out the ignition, easy fix.

Thanks to the Hawkes Bay Classic Motorcycle Club, they always put on a well organised, well run event. See you next year.

Lloyd Williams



Andrew's well travelled LE Velocette



1980s line-up



Nice 68 Commando 750S



1990 Ducati 900SS



A matching pair of Tiger110s in the1950s Line-up

MNZ Hall of fame AARON SLIGHT



Born: 1966

Inducted into MNZ Hall of Fame: 2019

Aaron Slight has to be one of New Zealand's most successful international motorcycle road racers. Coming from the Wairarapa town of Masterton, the young Slight took up motocross at the age of twelve. It was after the tragic death of fellow Masterton racer Peter Blackwood, in 1984, that Slight began his road race career, when his employer Ross Gregory offered Blackwood's bikes to ride – a Yamaha RZ250 and a 350. Learning his craft over the next few years on machines from 250cc to 1000cc, he would win many races in New Zealand. By the mid to late 1980s, Slight had won the New Zealand 250 Production Championship and the Castrol 6 Hour Production race twice, moving to Australia with his own Yamaha TZR250 to gather valuable experience. In 1988, he left New Zealand to race with the Super Angel Team in Japan but had little success. The campaign did, however, lead to his first major ride in 1989 when he joined Team Kawasaki Australia alongside Robbie Phillis in the Australian Superbike Championship, finishing third at the end of the season. Slight had a serious crash in Japan the following year, which almost curtailed his career. He would spend much of that year recovering from a very badly injured hand.

His big break came with Team Kawasaki Australia when he won the 1991 Australian Superbike Championship, along with the Pan Pacific Championship. He continued racing in Australia, Asia and New Zealand before

being signed to contest the 1992 World Superbike Championship for the official Kawasaki factory team. He won his first WSBK race in Spain that year.

He took his second WSBK race victory in Italy and won the Suzuka 8 Hour in Japan for the first time in 1993, before switching from Kawasaki to Honda for the 1994 season.

Slight would also win the Suzuka 8 Hour in 1994 and 1995 for Honda, a hat trick record that would last for over twenty years. It took until 2018 for Yamaha factory rider Kats Nagasuka to win the famous race four years in a row, breaking Slight's long-standing record.

Coming so close to winning the World Superbike Championship on several occasions, the title of being World Champion eluded Slight. However his racing record speaks for itself:

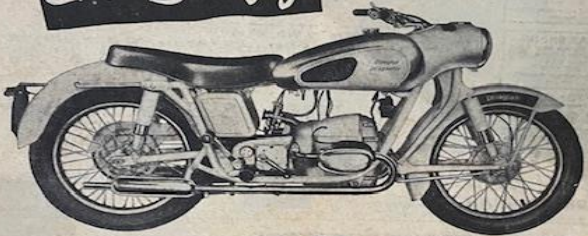
- 229 World Championship starts (more than any other New Zealander in any World Championship)
- 8 WSBK pole positions
- 13 WSBK wins
- 87 WSBK podium finishes
- 26 WSBK fastest laps
- 2nd in WSBK Championship in 1996 and 1998
- 3rd in the WSBK Championship in 1993, 94, 95 and 1997
- 4th in the WSBK Championship in 1999
- 6th in the WSBK Championship in 1992
- 8th in the WSBK Championship in 2000 (missed much of the season after brain surgery)
- NZ 250 Production Champion
- 2 times winner of the Castrol 6 Hour
- 3 times winner of the Suzuka 8 Hour

Recovering from major brain surgery in his final year in 2000 and returning to the WSBK competition after just three months defied all doctors' expectations. Slight only competed from round seven and would still finish his final year in the World Championship in eighth place.

Aaron went on to race British touring cars with some success before returning home to Masterton where he manages various property and business interests.

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1955 add for a douglas



About to depart to Marton





Sunbeam add



September kick start and shed visit



Two stroke parking



Doug's Yamaha



Arriving at Russell's



Panther



Not many of these around



Sam arriving on the Frances-Barnett



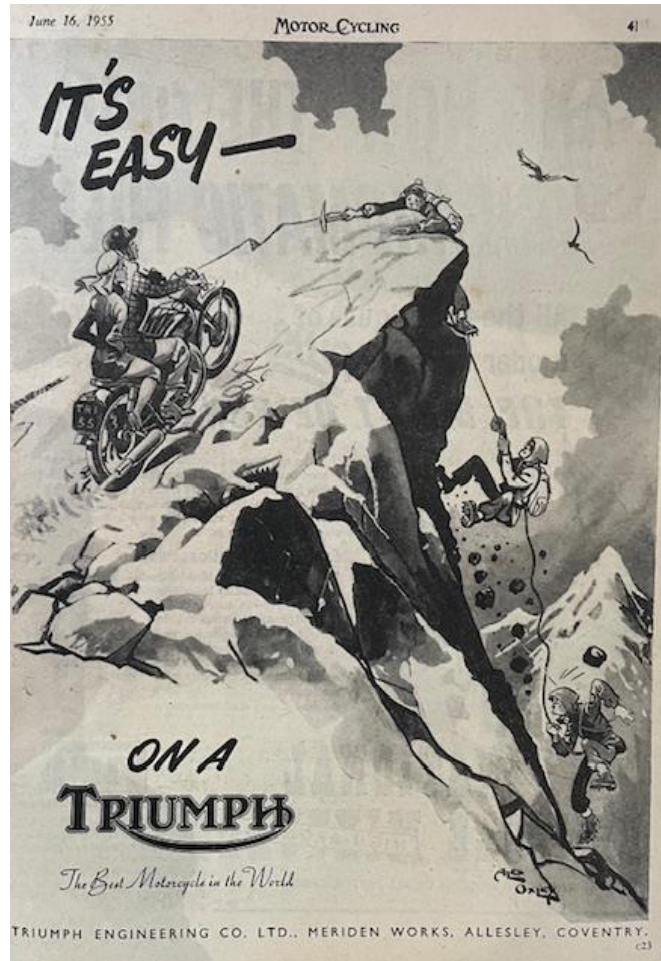
225 Two stroke power



Stafford's new Gorilla



Dave and his pillion







Visitor to moto71 today



Must put her in the shed

A note to our members if you have pictures and\or a story from a ride you have been on if you Email me I can include it in our magazine

Thanks

Mike my Email is mikethebike.mjr@gmail.com

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Coming up

OCTOBER

11th Wanganui classic motorcycle club

Memorial Ride leaving London Street BP 10.00am

31st-01st NZCMRR Spring Classic at Manfeild

November

8th BSA bantum big day out Feilding Coachouse museum 9.30am

New bantum's and other bikes welcome

15th WCC swap meet Karapiro

2027

SEPTEMBER

17th -19th Hawkes bay CMCC's 50th anniversary National Rally

Stoney creek Ranch

MotoGP	
2026 CALENDAR	
 FEB MAR 27-01 THAILAND	 JUL JUL 10-12 SACHSENINGEN GERMANY
 MAR MAR 20-22 GOSSANIA BRAZIL	 AUG AUG 07-09 SILVERSTONE GREAT BRITAIN
 MAR MAR 27-29 AUTON USA	 AUG AUG 28-30 MOTORLAND ARAGON
 APR APR 10-12 LUSAIL QATAR	 SEP SEP 11-13 MISANO SAN MARINO
 APR APR 24-26 JEREZ SPAIN	 SEP SEP 18-20 SPIELBERG AUSTRIA
 MAY MAY 08-10 LE MANS FRANCE	 OCT OCT 02-04 MOTEGI JAPAN
 MAY MAY 15-17 BARCELONA CATALONIA	 OCT OCT 09-11 MANDALIKA INDONESIA
 MAY MAY 29-31 Mugello ITALY	 OCT OCT 29-31 PHILLIP ISLAND AUSTRALIA
 JUN JUN 05-07 BALATON HUNGARY	 OCT NOV 30-01 SEPANG MALAYSIA
 JUN JUN 19-21 BRNO CZECHIA	 NOV NOV 13-15 PORTIMAO PORTUGAL
 JUN JUN 26-28 Assen NETHERLANDS	 NOV NOV 20-22 CHESTE VALENCIA

Vehicle WOF changes coming up

Vehicle type and age	Current setting	From 1 Nov 2026	Eligibility / Phasing
New light vehicles	Second WoF at 3 years	Second WoF at 4 years	From 1 Nov 2026
Light vehicles (4–14 yrs) first phase	Annual WoF	WoF every 2 years	From 1 Nov 2026 for light vehicles registered on/after 1 Nov 2019
Light vehicles (4–14 yrs) second phase	Annual WoF	WoF every 2 years	From 1 Nov 2027 for light vehicles registered between 1 Nov 2013 – 31 Oct 2019
Light vehicles (14 to 26 yrs)	Annual WoF	Annual WoF (no change)	No change
Light vehicles (26 yrs+ registered before 1 January 2000)	WoF every 6 months	Annual WoF	From 1 Nov 2026
Motorcycles (registered before 1 January 2000)	WoF every 6 months	Annual WoF	From 1 Nov 2026
Motorcycles (registered from 1 January 2000)	Annual WoF	Annual WoF (no change)	No change
Light rental vehicles (CoF-A)	CoF A every 6 months	Annual CoF A	All light rental vehicles eligible from 1 Nov 2026

